

aristocratic patrons. He wrote piano sonatas, including the famous “Pathétique” published in 1799; began composing string quartets from 1798; and in 1800 premiered his First Symphony at Vienna’s Burgtheater. His music of this early period was still rooted in the past, showing the influence of both Mozart and Haydn, but it was already recognized by contemporaries as daringly innovative. Beethoven was also in demand as a music teacher, his famous pupils including Carl Czerny, who would later premiere two of his master’s piano concertos. He was distressingly prone to falling in love with his female pupils, including Josephine von Brunsvik (see [box](#)), whom he taught from 1799, and Giulietta Guicciardi, to whom the “Moonlight” Sonata was dedicated in 1802. These were women of high birth, never likely to marry a piano teacher, however distinguished.



“MOONLIGHT” SONATA

This score of Beethoven’s Piano Sonata No. 14 is in the composer’s own hand. It was later named the “Moonlight” Sonata after the German critic Ludwig Rellstab compared its first movement to the sight of moonlight reflected in Lake Lucerne.